

November

23

Also on this day

543 BCE In ancient Greece, **Thespis of Icaria** became the first person on record to act as a character in a play on stage.

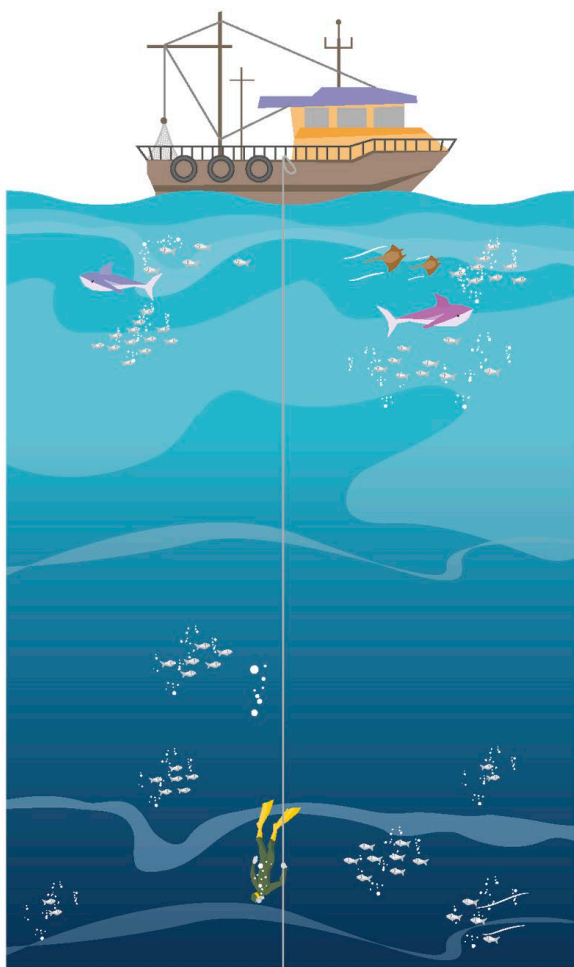
1868 French inventor **Louis Ducos du Hauron** filed a patent for a process that added colour to photographs, marking the beginning of colour photography.

1963 The first episode of the British science-fiction TV show *Doctor Who* went on air.

1976

Deep dive

French diver Jacques Mayol attempted a free dive from a boat off the coast of the island of Elba, Italy. He was able to reach a depth of 100 m (330 ft) without any breathing equipment, making him the first diver to achieve this extraordinary feat.



Born this day

1805 Mary Seacole, British-Jamaican nurse. During the Crimean War, she set up the “British Hotel”, where wounded soldiers could be treated for their injuries.

1915 Anne Burns, British aeronautical engineer and glider pilot. She was the first woman to cross the English Channel in a glider.

Queen Wilhelmina

1890

When King William III of the Netherlands died without a male heir, a law was passed to allow his daughter, Princess Wilhelmina, to take the throne. She became queen at the age of 10, and would later keep her country out of World War I.

